

Chris Lam

Product Design Engineer for AI-native products

whoischrislam@gmail.com · <https://whoischrislam.github.io> · www.linkedin.com/in/whoischrislam · github.com/whoischrislam · dribbble.com/whoischrislam

Remote US from Honolulu, HI · Works West Coast hours · Quarterly Bay Area and Seattle travel

SUMMARY

Product design engineer with 14 years shipping healthcare, creative, developer, and consumer software. Built my career in product design, including early roles at Clover Health, GoodRx, Pathstream, and StartPlaying, then deliberately deepened into production engineering. Today I own products end to end: research, interaction design, design systems, React/TypeScript/Python implementation, agent architecture, evals, and production verification. Recent work includes a voice-AI system with deterministic safety controls and collaborative game-development tooling with a custom real-time engine. Seeking senior or lead IC design-engineering roles on AI-native teams.

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & CPTO · y30

Mar 2026 to Present · Voice AI for older adults and their care teams.

- Built an FSM safety engine where crisis paths are deterministic code, not prompt instructions, a hard state the model cannot override.
- Architected a streaming speech-to-text to LLM to text-to-speech pipeline (multi-provider, deep fallback) fronted by a deterministic state machine.
- Scoped the language model to phrasing and warmth while conversation flow runs as a deterministic state machine; about half of routing decisions resolve with no model call.
- Built the first version in TypeScript, then deliberately rewrote it in Python to fit the real-time voice framework, carrying the state-machine architecture and safety model across the rewrite.
- Designed elder-first voice UX: no app, no screen, no login, just a phone call.
- 1,389 commits, 127 test files.

Entrepreneur in Residence · Blue Startups

Jul 2024 to Nov 2024 · Concurrent with PlaySesh, during a pivot. Conducted design and product audits for 10 early-stage startups in cohort 16. Advised on product strategy, MVP scope, and design-to-engineering handoffs.

Co-Founder & CEO · PlaySesh

Jan 2024 to Mar 2026 · Collaborative game development tools for indie developers, built inside Discord. Started while finishing at Modus Create.

- Shipped 0 to 1 alone in Vanilla JS, Express, and Supabase before recruiting co-founders; primary engineer who authored 1,147 of the project's 1,790 commits, with 291 passing tests and zero ad spend.
- Authored the core real-time engine: a custom operation-based sync protocol on Cloudflare Durable Objects, including authoritative ordering and WebSocket reconnection logic, after moving off an off-the-shelf canvas library.
- Grew organically to 6,220 authorized Discord accounts and 138 server installs, peaking at 1,043 monthly active users (January 2026). Discord counts as of August 1, 2026.
- Pivoted from social gaming to game dev tooling based on user behavior signal.

Software Engineer · Modus Create

Jun 2023 to Feb 2024 · Shipped dark mode for JIRA and Confluence Cloud (500K+ enterprise users). Owned design, engineering implementation, and internal dev documentation. Contributed to the CI/CD pipeline with Docker Compose.

Founding Product Designer · StartPlaying

Jul 2022 to Jan 2023 · First designer at a YC W20, a16z-backed seed-stage TTRPG marketplace. Redesigned the payment experience with Stripe for 100% on-time payouts; shipped a game master onboarding flow.

Lead Product Designer · doc.ai (acquired by Sharecare)

Feb 2021 to Oct 2021 · Hired by doc.ai; exited under Sharecare paperwork after the acquisition. Rescue hire brought in to ship a clinical-studies product through the acquisition. Sharecare later went public (NASDAQ: SHCR, 2021).

Senior Product Design Manager · Pathstream

Jun 2019 to Nov 2020 · Operated as lead designer. First design hire at a career-development and LMS platform.

- Redesigned the core lesson experience on a live platform, mid-cohort, without forcing a rewrite of 60-80 hours of existing course content.

- Built the platform's design system in React with Storybook, on top of Ant Design.
- Ran the research that set the direction: a 26-screen product audit in week three, three rounds of usability testing, five course-author co-design sessions, and instructor interviews.
- Audited the interface library and found the drift: sixteen colours where four greys were all labelled Text, two different values both called Primary Button, body copy at four sizes, and a 10.3px type size shipping to adult learners.

Lead Product Designer · Iodine (acquired by GoodRx)

Apr 2017 to Oct 2018 · First full-time designer, on GoodRx's special research and experimentation team. Title was self-assigned. A contractor preceded him and never converted. GoodRx later IPO'd (NASDAQ: GDRX).

- Redesigned the coupon redemption flow; conversion rate 2% to 5%.
- Ran a series of conversion projects across the drug pages: 10% lift on mobile, 25% on desktop.
- Contributed to GoodRx Research data visualizations referenced in the New York Times and on Good Morning America / ABC News.
- Iodine.com won the Webby for Best Health Website (2018). I was the product's designer.
- Built 50-state prescription-price fact sheets with GoodRx co-CEO Doug Hirsch, used in advocacy around S.2554 and S.2553 on drug price transparency.

Designer · Clover Health

Jul 2015 to Sep 2016 · Second designer, joined pre-seed when the title was deliberately broad. Operated as a product design lead. Clover later IPO'd (NYSE: CLOV).

- Helped build the design function as the second designer: established how design, engineering, and product worked together, sat in product development, and co-wrote PRDs with the product manager.
- Redesigned the nurse practitioner home-visit iPad web app end to end through contextual shadowing. about 7-8x ROI on the increase in revenue; saved ~2 hours per nurse per day.
- Led cross-functional alignment across design, engineering, product, data science, and medical.

Product Designer · TaskRabbit

May 2014 to Mar 2015 · Worked on the 2014 rebrand; TaskRabbit later acquired by IKEA (2017).

- Hired by founder and CEO Leah Busque onto a new design team as TaskRabbit moved from bidding to direct hire. Owned the Tasker side of the experience outright and contributed to the consumer side.
- Tasker NPS recovered from about -5 in mid-2014 to the mid-50s; Client NPS to the high-40s.

User Experience Designer · Amazon

Apr 2012 to Sep 2013

- Prototyped the buy-and-gift Prime flow, projected to drive 1M+ new subscribers.
- Partnered with Samsung on the Amazon Prime Music app for the Samsung Shape wireless speaker.

EDUCATION

MS, Human-Centered Design & Engineering · University of Washington · 2012

BS, Informatics, Human-Computer Interaction · University of Washington · 2010

SKILLS

Product & Design: Product design (0 to 1) · Interaction design · Design systems · Design tokens · Storybook & Chromatic · UX research · Prototyping · Information architecture · WCAG accessibility · Product strategy · Elder-care UX

Production Engineering: React · TypeScript · Python · Next.js · HTML/CSS · Vanilla JS · Supabase · Firebase · PostgreSQL · Cloudflare Workers · Docker · CI/CD · Test-driven development · Real-time systems · Telemetry & instrumentation

AI-Native Systems: Agent UX · LLM orchestration · Multi-agent orchestration · Agentic systems · Evals & evaluation UX · Guardrails & deterministic safety control · FSM/LLM safety · Prompt & system-instruction design · Provenance & human-AI oversight · Agent frameworks · MCP · LiveKit · Real-time STT/TTS · Voice AI